



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Abraham's Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://stabrahams.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Saint Abraham's Classical Christian Academy (St. Abe's) presents a pronounced classical Christian program rooted in the Liberal Arts Tradition. Public materials from the school emphasize a discipleship-centered, virtue-focused education anchored in theology, worship, and a commitment to forming character through a structured Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) approach. The school explicitly frames education as formation rather than mere information, highlighting the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, the Great Books tradition, and a pedagogy that blends memory work, singing, and liturgical practices with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric in the upper grades. Overall, the school aligns strongly with classical education principles across religious foundations, purpose/goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong theological grounding; explicit emphasis on the Triune God, Word, and World; liturgical/worship practices noted.
- Purpose and Goal: Formation-centered and virtue-oriented; commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty; lenses of liberal arts and Great Books.
- Curriculum: Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin study, biblically-informed history, and a robust liberal arts orientation.
- Pedagogy: Balanced approach including contemplative/restful elements (scholé-like) and Socratic/seminar-style discourse in upper grades, plus memorization and chant in early grades.
- Faculty: Headmaster-led community with a living-curriculum ethos; clear teacher-centrist modeling; active governance by a parent-involved board.
- Parents & Community: Emphasis on partnership with parents, campus visits, and family involvement; open invitation to engage with the school.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground a theistic, Trinitarian framework: "Triune God, His Word, and His World" and a mission focused on spiritual formation alongside academics. The school frames faith as central to education and character formation. - Liturgical/communal practices are referenced (e.g., daily chapel, singing, worship), indicating liturgical life as part of the education process. - The school explicitly states education is about virtue and alignment with God's will, integrating theology with curricular aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, worship, sacred, imago Dei, Word, Triune God, wisdom. The site repeatedly ties virtue formation and worship to learning. - Negative keywords present: none evident (no signal of relativism, secular humanism, or values-neutral stance).

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate transcendental moral realism and a grounded theological orientation, with explicit liturgical/community practices. This strongly satisfies the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria for CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation and virtue rather than job preparation, describing education as formation aimed at human excellence and virtue. The mission centers on pursuing truth, goodness, and

beauty. - Great Books/Great Conversation and the liberal-arts orientation are foregrounded as core aims; the school stresses formation of character and wisdom rather than mere information. - Public materials reference goals like “formation of virtue and wisdom” and a graduate vision grounded in classical liberal arts, with a regional mission to foster Christian discipleship and classical learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, Great Books/Great Conversation, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé, classical heritage, soul craft, moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: references to “college and career ready” or workforce-prep framing appear only as tension against a job-focused narrative (the public-facing material emphasizes formation over job-training). This aligns with the Negative signal in the lexicon.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, undergirded by the Great Books/liberal-arts tradition, with explicit caution against reducing education to workforce prep. This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described in terms of liberal arts fundamentals—grammar, logic, rhetoric—and includes Great Books, primary sources, Latin, history, and Western civilization. Students study history through a biblical/Christian framework rather than as “social studies.” The curriculum progression aligns with the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric model. - References to Great Books, the Great Conversation, and the Liberal Arts Tradition are explicit, with emphasis on learning through primary sources and classical texts. - The school frames education as formation and wonder, with memory-based and oral/recitation practices as part of the pedagogy. Latin study and classical languages are part of the program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classics, Latin, history, Western civilization, memory, recitation, Socratic texts, dialectic, wonder. - Negative keywords present: minimal signals of project-based learning dominance or social-studies-centric framing; the curriculum centers on classical approaches rather than modern alternatives. The lexicon's negative signals about social studies vs. history are not evidenced in the school's explicit curriculum framing.

Why this rating - The school's materials map almost perfectly to classical curriculum norms: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, biblical/historiographical framing of history, and a reverence for wonder. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical description includes contemplative/restful elements and scholé-oriented learning, alongside rigorous upper-level Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and rhetoric instruction in later grades. Grammar stage emphasizes memory work and chant; upper grades emphasize Socratic/dialogic inquiry and rhetoric. - Specific references to Socratic questioning and dialogue in advanced grades, and upper-school opportunities for speeches and rhetorical training, align with classical pedagogy. - Lower-school practices include singing, chanting, and memory-driven activities, consistent with contemplative and mnemonic pedagogy. The Headmaster's notes indicate daily chapel and singing as part of the educational rhythm.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, rest, wonder, Socratic questioning, seminar, dialectic, recitation/narration, chanting, rhetoric, debate, memory-work, liturgical integration. - Negative keywords present: no explicit emphasis on experiential/project-based learning; the materials resist a purely constructivist/experiential-only approach. The classical lexicon would flag “experiential learning” as a negative signal, which is not the core driver here.

Why this rating - The school's pedagogy aligns with classical norms: a memory-based, contemplative foundational phase, moving toward Socratic inquiry and rhetoric in upper grades. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Headmaster is presented as a central mentor and model of virtue; the school emphasizes a living curriculum and a community of teachers who model virtue, skill, and knowledge. There are explicit references to a portrait or profile of teacher ideals and a “faculty as the living curriculum.” The governance includes a Board of Directors composed of parents, educators, and community leaders.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, mentorship, master/teacher imagery, headmaster leadership. - Negative keywords present: none evident (the materials do not signal the “facilitator” or “guides-on-the-side” model nor certification-driven jargon lacking classical context).

Why this rating - The faculty model emphasizes virtuous mentorship and a living curriculum, consistent with classical education expectations. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes partnerships with parents and a vision that parents are co-teachers or integral partners in the educational project. The governance structure includes parent involvement (Board composition includes parents). The school invites campus visits and engagement (open-door policy for visits; “Plan a visit” calls to action).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups/seminars/book clubs, open campus, parent involvement, campus visits. - Negative keywords present: no strong consumer/customer language identified; the materials frame parents as collaborators rather than customers. The lexicon warns about consumer language as a negative signal, which is not evident here.

Why this rating - The school presents robust parent partnership, open engagement, and community involvement consistent with classical-paradigms of parents as co-educators. CLASSICAL.

Overall Assessment - Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the clearly CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories.
- If desired as minor refinements (not required for CLASSICAL status), the school could more explicitly spotlight:
- A formal, published articulation of parents as co-educators in all communication and a documented “Parent Formation” program (book studies, lectures, or study groups) to strengthen the explicit connector between parent education and classroom formation.
- A concise, public-facing overview of the Great Books/Great Conversation components and the canonical texts used in each grade band to enhance transparency for prospective families.
- A brief summary of the governance model and teacher-professional development aligned with classical pedagogy to further emphasize “living curriculum” in practice.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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